8.6.1 Searching for movies by title

Let's say we want to find movies by searching for a word in the title field ("Godfather", for example). We use the `_search` endpoint on the `movies` index with the query parameter `Godfather` as the `title` attribute.

Listing 8.5 Search query to fetch movies matching "Godfather"

```
GET movies/_search?q=title:Godfather
```

The URL is composed of the `_search` endpoint followed by the query represented by the letter `q`. This query returns all movies with a title matching the word "Godfather" (we should get two movies in the response: *The Godfather Part I* and *Part II*).

To search for movies matching multiple words, we can add the titles as search keywords with a space between them. The following query searches for all movies matching the words "Godfather", "Knight", and "Shawshank".

Listing 8.6 Searching for movies by multiple words

```
GET movies/_search?q=title:Godfather Knight Shawshank
```

This query returns four movie titles: *The Shawshank Redemption*, *The Dark Knight*, *The Godfather Part I*, and *The Godfather Part II*. Note that by default, Elasticsearch uses the `OR` operator between the query inputs, so we don't need to specify it (it is assumed to be present implicitly).

If we check the relevancy scores, *The Shawshank Redemption* and *The Dark Knight* received the same score (3.085904), and *The Godfather Part I* scored a bit higher than *The Godfather Part II*. We can ask Elasticsearch to explain how it derived this scoring by passing an `explain` flag:

```
GET movies/_search?q=title:Godfather Knight Shawshank&explain=true
```

We discuss the `explain` flag in section 8.8.3.

cURL format

The cURL equivalent for the code in listing 8.6 is

```
curl -XGET "http://localhost:9200/movies/_search?q=title:Godfather
            Knight Shawshank"
```

You can generate a cURL command automatically by clicking the wrench icon next to the Play button in the Dev Tools UI, as shown in the figure.

